WHAT IS THE ACTION PLAN JOURNAL?

Whenever I read for pleasure, I listen to an audiobook or speed read. When I read to learn, I make some notes as I go through the chapters. When I read a book for teaching and skill improvement, I take copious notes on the blank pages in both the front and back. I write down the definitions of new words in the back and unconventional phrases, meanings in the front. This is a technique that I discovered from the book, xxxxx.

By only keeping a diary and writing down past experiences will not lead to significant personal growth.

Journaling is a tool if you want to reflect and grow personally.

"Journaling helps release mental blockades and become more précised about your thoughts" Sinem Gunel, Medium.

Federal procurement contracting is a Masters Program. This is not a home study course; this is not a trade school. This is not a weekend seminar or just a mindset boot camp. This is a journey that will be exhausting, invigorating, heart clenching and soul searching. You will have to dig deep, take a few punches, overcome self-doubt and make a commitment.

But just our college athlete turned space explorer, Carol Craig, said in our podcast interview episode 069; "There's a point where I was saying, what if I go bankrupt? What if, what if, you know? And just like, oh my gosh. But having gone through some other stuff, I'm still like, this is so much fun. I enjoy what I'm doing. I'm super blessed."

This past weekend one of our GovCon EDU students won a $21million contract for transportation readiness. We were laughing, crying, our emotions were high; I was yelling in the store. It was an immense feeling that overtook the two of us. Having worked with him on this from the onset, I remember him being inspired after watching Wesley, the 16 y/o government contractor interview I did that month.

Chris made a decision to put it all on the line and step outside of his comfort zone taking action. We even joked that had it not been for that gut-wrenching decision he would have simply been another person watching the award go by and stating how he would just give it a shot the next year.

At the end, he said Eric, you changed my life. Having gone through a few life-altering decisions in the past, I know how significant that statement was.

That is why I decided to enhance the user experience for maximum learning, retaining information, and goal achievement to create this journal as the medium. We here at GovCon Giants have many resources available but nothing you can carry around in your hand and take with you each day.

I wanted something that you can visually see without the interruptions of a screen distracting you from quite much needed self-reflection and introspective time.

The Action Plan Journal

One of my favorite Jim Rohn quotes is that most people are hard workers but poor thinkers.

Many of us are not underachieving due to our inability to work hard and give it all we got. We simply do not have the tools and resources available to achieve the goals that we set out for ourselves. Once we are afforded the tools, resources we then need to be trained in the proper ways to effectively use these techniques to increase our knowledge making us more valuable. You can go from $20/hour to $200/hour in value if you increased you skill set. You can go from $200/hour to $2000/hour if then again increase your skillset and become more valuable.

The idea is to learn a trade of value and deliver upon time and time again, achieving consistent results. Once you can achieve predictive results, you now have become a master of that particular craft.

In the Action Plan Journal, we want to help you become a person of significant value in the world of federal contracting.

When I first started out making YouTube videos, I knew that people needed steps to follow. So I decided to create an Action Plan of activates for people to do throughout the course of the year to help advance their GovCon Journey. While this was helpful and useful to many it was not beneficial to all people. What I learned was that simply listing a set of steps to follow was not powerful enough to trigger activates that lead to real change.

In recent years after studying wealth and successful people, I've come to learn about the power of journaling. Writing down memories and experiences in a diary helps to do proper self-reflection and get to a better understanding of who you are. It is a lot like meditating: it requires patience and commitment. Many of the best minds that we know admire and respect use some form of journaling to capture their ideas in one place and reflect on activities from weeks, months or even years ago.

Taking what I know about the significance of journaling and having the Action Plan template, I decided that we would make a journal.

ARE YOU READY?

ASSESSMENTS AND REVIEWS

The Initial Assessment: To ensure you identify what you have done and what you need to do.

Progress Review: You'll review your progress to see what you have accomplished and what you may need extra work on.

Test fast, fail fast, adjust fast. —TOM PETERS

HOW IMPORTANT IS GOAL SETTING?

You are 42 percent more likely to achieve your goals if you write them down. Writing your goals down not only forces you to get clear on what, exactly, it is that you want to accomplish, but doing so plays a part in motivating you to complete the tasks necessary for your success.

While 60 percent of people abandon their resolutions within six months, 25 percent of people abandon them within a mere 7 days.

Going through the Action Plan journal will help you NOT fall into that 25 or 60 percentile. The more time you can spend discussing, reviewing, emerging yourself into this plan the more likely you are to succeed.

This is a must have toolkit to help you submerge your brain into this world and take on a conviction that this will happen for you.

Government Acronyms

ACO	Administrative Contracting Officer
AIMS	Advertising and Integrated Marketing Solutions
BAFO	Best and Final Offer
BOA	Basis of Award
BOM	Bill of Material
BPA / B&P	Blanket Purchase Agreement
CACO	Corporate Administrative Contracting Officer
CAGE	Commercial and Government Entity
CAS	Cost Accounting Standards
CAV	Contractor Assistance Visit
CCR	Central Contractor Registration (now part of SAM)
CDM	Continuous Diagnostics and Mitigation
CDRL	Contract Data Requirements List
CLIN	Contract Line Item Number
CO / COR / KO	Contracting Officer
COMSATCOM	Commercial Satellite Communications
COTR	Contracting Officer's Technical Representative
COTS	Commercial Off-The-Shelf
CPARS	Contractor Performance Assessment Review System
CPFF	Cost Plus Fixed Fee
CSP	Commercial Sales Practices
CTA	Contractor Teaming Arrangement
D&B	Dun & Bradstreet
DACO	Divisional Administrative Contracting Officer
DAR	Defense Acquisition Regulation
DCAA	Defense Contract Audit Agency
DCMA	Defense Contract Management Agency
DFARS	Defense Federal Acquisition Regulations Supplement
DHS	Department of Homeland Security
DOD	Department of Defense
DOJ	Department of Justice
DoR	Dealer of Record
DOT	Department of Transportation
DUNS	Data Universal Numbering System
EAC	Estimate at Completion
EDI	Electronic Data Interchange
EDWOSB	Economically Disadvantaged Woman-Owned Small Business
EEO	Equal Employment Opportunity
EPA	Economic Price Adjustment

EPEAT	Electronic Products Environmental Assessment Tool
EPLS	Excluded Parties List System (now part of SAM)
ERM	Electronic Records Management
eSRS	Electronic Subcontracting Reporting System
EULA	End-User License Agreement
ETC	Estimate to Complete
EVMS	Earned Value Management System
FAI	Federal Acquisition Institute
FAR	Federal Acquisition Regulation
FAS	Federal Acquisition Service
FBO	Federal Business Opportunities (also known as FedBizOpps)
FFP	Firm Fixed Price
FOIA	Freedom of Information Act
FPDS	Federal Procurement Data System
FPR	Final Proposal Revision
FPRA	Forward Pricing Rate Agreement
FPT	Formatted Product Tool
FSC	Federal Supply Class
FSS	Federal Supply Schedule
FSSI	Federal Strategic Sourcing Initiative
FTA	Free Trade Agreement
FY	Fiscal Year
GAO	Government Accountability Office
GEOINT	Geospatial Intelligence
GPA	Government Procurement Agreement
GSA	General Services Administration
GSAM	General Services Administration Manual
GWAC	Government Wide Acquisition Contract
HACS	Highly Adaptive Cybersecurity Services
HCaTS	Human Capital and Training Solutions
HHS	Department of Health and Human Services
HSPD	Homeland Security Presidential Directive
HUBZone	Historically Underutilized Business Zone
ICS	Incurred Cost Submission
IDIQ	Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity
IFF	Industrial Funding Fee
IOA	Industrial Operations Analyst
IPS	Identity Protection Services
IRAD / IR&D	Independent Research and Development
ISR	Individual Subcontracting Report

ITAR	International Traffic in Arms Regulations
JWOD	Javits-Wagner-O"Day Program
LOS	Letter of Supply
MAP	Minimum Advertised Price
MAS	Multiple Award Schedule
MFC	Most Favored Customer
MMAS	Material Management Accounting System
MOBIS	Mission Oriented Business Integrated Services
MOT	Maximum Order Threshold
NAICS	North American Industrial Classification Standard
NDAA	National Defense Authorization Act
OCONUS	Outside Continental United States
ODC	Other Direct Costs
OIG	Office of Inspector General
OMB	Office of Management and Budget
ORCA	Online Representations and Certifications Application (now part of SAM)
OSBDU	Office of Small and Disadvantaged Business Utilization
PBS	Public Buildings Services
PCO	Procurement Contracting Officer
PES	Professional Engineering Services
PIV	Personal Identification Verification (Federal)
PO	Purchase Order
PPIRS	Past Performance Information Retrieval System
PRC	Price Reduction Clause
PSC	Product and Service Codes
PSS	Professional Services Schedule
PTAC	Procurement Technical Assistance Center
PWS	Performance Work Statement
QAP	Quality Assurance Plan
RFI	Request for Information
RFP	Request for Proposal
RFQ	Request for Quote
SAM	System for Award Management
SAT	Simplified Acquisition Threshold
SBA	Small Business Administration
SBDC	Small Business Development Center
SCA	Service Contract Act
SCLS	Service Contract Labor Standards
SDVOSB	Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business
SIC	Standard Industrial Classification

SIN	Special Item Number
SIP	Schedule Input Program
SOW	Statement of Work
SSQ	Schedule Sales Query
SSR	Summary Subcontracting Report
T&C	Terms and Conditions
T&M	Time and Materials
TAA	Trade Agreements Act
TAPS	Temporary Administrative & Professional Staffing Services
TCPD	Truthful Cost or Pricing Data
TDR	Transactional Data Reporting
TiN	Truth in Negotiations Act
Ts&Cs	Terms and Conditions
USC	United States Code
USDA	United States Department of Agriculture
VA	Department of Veterans Affairs
VOSB	Veteran-Owned Small-Business
VSC	Vendor Support Center
WAWF	Wide Area Workflow
WDOL	Wages Department of Labor
WOSB	Woman-Owned Small Business
WTO	World Trade Organization

Lets Begin

Initial Assessment

Company	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
Have you established a solid foundation for your company.	Does your company need to update or create a website?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have access to a personal email address from your company?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have a capability statement for your company?	☐YES ☐NO	
Setup	**Ask yourself...**		**Action Plan**
Did you modify or register your company on third party platforms.	Does your company need to register with DUNS?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Is your company registered with SAM?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Is your company's DSBS profile completed?	☐YES ☐NO	
Research			**Action Plan**
Identify what information is revelant for your desired agency.	Have you completed a forecast list for your desired agencies?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have the information for a point of contact at the desired agencies?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you found the OSDBUs in charge of the desired agencies?	☐YES ☐NO	

Research (cont.)	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
The goal here is to establish a solid foundation for your company.	Have you developed or were given a register bidders list?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you attended site visits?	☐YES ☐NO	
Events	**Ask yourself...**		**Action Plan**
Are you prepared to attend an industry conference meeting?	Have you registered at your local PTAC?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you attended industry specific events?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you contacted OSDBUs for recommended events?	☐YES ☐NO	

Additional notes:

Part 1
Company setup and necessary registration

Note

The requirements for starting a business will vary depending on what state you are in. Businesses need to be aware of all the state laws and regulations that pertain to them. These include tax regulations, licensing requirements, and more. So, be sure to visit your particular state's website for more information.

Most businesses have the same basic steps to start, however, when jumping into the government contract arena there will be extra steps to take.

In this chapter, you will learn what needs to be completed before stepping further into the world of government contracting. At the end of each section there will be objectives to help keep you on track.

Set up Supplier Trade Accounts

Steps before you beginning applying:		
☐ TIN/EIN number	☐ Register your business with your state	☐ Established a DUNS number

Information to keep on hand when applying:

Business name: _____

TIN/EIN number: _____

Business Address: _____

_____

Shipping Address: _____

_____

Business email address: _____

- Use your business name on the application.
- Be consistent in the way you list your business name, address, contact number, etc
- Avoid using personal information such as your Social Security number whenever possible.
- Take down your account number and the day you opened up the account. It might take 60 days for a new account to appear on your company credit reports.
- Business might need to be established at least 30 days.
- No derogatory reporting or delinquencies against your business.

"My biggest motivation? Just to keep challenging myself. I see life almost like one long University education that I never had — every day I'm learning something new."
-Richard Branson, founder Virgin Group

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Recommended source:
Why it is an absolute must for Government Contractors - https://youtu.be/fwTB-e6E81w

Identify NAICS codes (2or3)

NAICS (pronounced NAKES) Code was created by Federal Statistical Agencies for the collection, analysis and publication of statistical data related to the US Economy.

- Search what similar business NAICS codes are.
- Search within https://www.naics.com/search/ using keywords.
- Be sure to read the Full NAICS code definition to make sure that it defines your business

NAICS code	NAICS Title	keywords

"Every time you state what you want or believe, you're the first to hear it. It's a message to both you and others about what you think is possible. Don't put a ceiling on yourself."
– Oprah Winfrey, media proprietor

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Recommended Source:
Choosing the wrong NAICS code can cost you millions!!- https://youtu.be/BAeWQix2sM4

Company website and email

Company website url:

Custom business email:

Who will be assisting you in the creation/updating of this website?

Give a brief company description:

What will be your Call to Action on your website?

Will there be a need for a Past Performances area?

Will there be a catalog for products or list of services available?

"Your work is going to fill a large part of your life, and the only way to be truly satisfied is to do what you believe is great work. And the only way to do great work is to love what you do."
– Steve Jobs, Co-founder, CEO, Chairman Apple Inc.

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Capability Statement

A capability statement shares the same idea as a personal resume. You will need to include information about your business that will be easy to digest. Make sure that a capability statement is tailored for each agencies need.

The following information is important to include in your company's Capability Statement:

- ☐ Name and company branding, slogan (if any)
- ☐ Summary description of the company
- ☐ Core Capabilities
- ☐ Registered company name
- ☐ DBA
- ☐ Year of incorporation
- ☐ State of incorporation
- ☐ Corporation type
- ☐ D-U-N-S Number
- ☐ CAGE Code
- ☐ Contact information
- ☐ Description of major services offered
- ☐ Federal Small Business Certifications
- ☐ Contract Vehicles in which you participate (Federal and State)
- ☐ State Certifications
- ☐ Local, Quasi, and Non-Government agencies you have served
- ☐ Major Clients (list the most important), Commercial and Government
- ☐ NAICS Codes
- ☐ Partners and authorized resellers
- ☐ Staff clearances and certifications

All this information should fit onto one (1) page using both front and back.

Your capability statement should reflect your business' branding colors. If you have none, make sure to reflect the professionalism of your business and not as a way to express your personality.

Use bullets, simple tables, and be sure to have a good reading flow.

Be sure to check for spelling and grammar.

"I knew that if I failed I wouldn't regret that, but I knew the one thing I might regret is not trying."
-Jeff Bezos, founder and CEO Amazon

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Recommended Source:
Capability Statement Do's Don'ts Resources and more - https://youtu.be/paUgQSU5v6c

Small Business Certifications

A business certification is an official document that eligible enterprises can apply for. Applying for a certification could lead to benefits like increased recognition, limited business competition, preferential treatment, set-aside contracts, and increased revenue.

8(a) Business Development:
This certificate is given by the SBA to business owners that have a economically disadvantage. Also, those that are socially disadvantaged and that face discrimination due to race, ethnicity, gender, or physical disability.

Eligibility	Benefits
• Be a small business based by SBA standards and throughout the 9 year program term. • Be at least 51% owned and controlled by US citizen that's socially disadvantaged and economically disadvantaged individual. • Be in business for two years and have the financial capacity to perform federal contracts. • Must have all principals in good character including not owning any outstanding federal finacial obligations.	• Obtain assistance through the 7(j) program. • May be able to receive 8(a) set-aside and sole source contract. • A Business Opportunity Specialist to assist you • Form joint ventures and teams via Mentor-Protege Program. • 5% government wide contracting goal as a small disadvantaged business.

HUBZone:
HUBZone small business is a SBA contracting program gives certificates to businesses that are established/resided in underutilized business zones.

Eligibility	Benefits
Be a small business based by SBA standards	• Be eligible for HUBZone set-asides and sole source contracts. • 10% price evaluation preference under full and open competition • 3% government wide contracting goal.

"Whether you think you can, or think you can't — you're right."
– Henry Ford, Founder Ford Motor Company

Woman Owned Small Business (WOSB):
This business certification is for women entrepreneurs.

Eligibility	Benefits
• Be a small business based by SBA standards. • 51% owned and controlledy by one or more women who are US citizens.	• 5% government wide contracting goal. • Eligible for set-aside contracts in certain underrepresentated industries.

Economically Disadvantaged Woman Owned Small Business (EDWOSB):
A business certificate for women entrepreneurs that are economically disadvantaged.

Eligibility	Benefits
• Be a small business based by SBA standards. • 51% owned and controlled by one or more women who are US citizens and are economically disadvantaged.	• 5% government wide contracting goal. • Eligible for set-aside contracts in certain underrepresentated industries. • Eligible for set-aside contracts in vertain additional underrepresentated industries.

Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business (SDVOSB):
This certificate is available to veterans with a service-related disability.

Eligibility	Benefits
• Be a small business based on SBA standards, at time of offer • 51% owned and controlled by a service disabled Veteran who has a service connected disability that has been determined by the Department of Veterans Affairs or Department od Defense.	• Preference for VA contracts over other types of business. • 3% government-wide contracting goal. • Be eligible for service disabled veteran set aside contracts from any agency.

Small (SB):
A small business is a privately owned corporation, partnership, or sole proprietorship that has fewer employees and less annual revenue than a corporation or regular-sized business.

Eligibility	Benefits
• The SBA will determine whether a business is considered small	• 23% government wide contracting goal. • Eligible for small business set aside contracts.

Small disadvantaged (SDB):
An SDB is a small business that is at least 51 percent owned by one or more individuals who are both socially and economically disadvantaged.

Eligibility	Benefits
• In it's primary industry NAICS code a business needs to be small by SBA standards. • 51% owned and controlled by one or more socially disadvantaged US citizens and be economically disadvantaged.	• 5% government wide contracting goal.

Which ones apply to your business?

Since some need to be applied through a third party, which facility will you go through?

"Don't limit yourself. Many people limit themselves to what they think they can do. You can go as far as your mind lets you. What you believe, remember, you can achieve."
– Mary Kay Ash, Founder Mary Kay Cosmetics

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Recommended Source:
Which federal small business programs really make you money!!!! How to qualify and apply!- https://youtu.be/5Yaik0Q5kkg

Dun and Bradstreet number

Does your company have an existing DUNS number: ☐YES ☐NO

DUNS number: _____

Business Name: _____
Street Address: _____
City and Zip Code: _____
State and Country: _____

Documents you may need for creating/modifying a DUNS number

☐Secretary of State Articles of Incorporation ☐Taxpayer ID number Confirmation Letter	☐Registration Amendment Document ☐Employer ID number Confirmation Letter
☐DBA/Assumed Name Certificate Filing ☐Purchase Order Representing Asset/Liability Exchange	☐Merger/Acquisition Agreement ☐Utility Bill
☐Lease Agreement ☐Invoice from a third party showing current Business Name and Address	☐Bank Statement ☐Partnership Agreement
☐Operating Agreement ☐Purchase Agreement	☐Merger/Acquisition ☐Probate documents authorizing ownership of business

Additional notes:

"You don't learn to walk by following rules. You learn by doing and falling over."
– Richard Branson, founder Virgin Group

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Recommended Source:
How to Apply for a DUNS Number - Eric Coffie- https://youtu.be/DtwYgWr2CJI

SAM.gov
Create your Login.gov account

1. Head to SAM.gov homepage and find the "Log In" button.
2. Here you'll select "Create an Account."
3. Next, you're going to enter your email address and click submit. A message will be sent to verify your email address.
4. There will be a link that will send you to the password creation page.
5. Enter your password. Afterwards, you will be led to an authentication method set-up menu for additional security.
6. Your options for authentication will include an mobile application, security key, phone, government employee id and backup codes. Select one and hit continue.
7. You have now successfully created your Login.gov account. Click agree and continue.

After the completion of your Login.gov account you'll need to check your entity registration status. When it is active you'll be able to continue creating SAM profile and find your MPIN.

Additional notes:

"When you find an idea that you just can't stop thinking about, that's probably a good one to pursue."
-Josh James, co-founder and CEO Omniture, founder and CEO Domo

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Create DSBS Profile

Registration in the DSBS can only be done while updating or while completing your SAM registration. If you have not done so please go back and finish your SAM registration.

Here are a list of items you may need for filling out your DSBS profile

- ☐ Name of business
- ☐ Trade Name (DBA/acronym)
- ☐ DUNS number
- ☐ Year established
- ☐ Ownership and Self-Certifications
- ☐ Current Principals
- ☐ Parent DUNS number (if applicable)
- ☐ Address
- ☐ Phone number
- ☐ DBE Certifications (and State)
- ☐ City/State/Zipcode
- ☐ Fax number
- ☐ Website
- ☐ Contact Person
- ☐ Legal structure
- ☐ Email address
- ☐ Contact Person's Title

Keywords

Be sure to add keywords that are relevant to your business.

Past Performances

Be sure to include past performances because it showcases the expertise your business is capable of. Be sure that the Contact Person is able to give out the information below.

- ☐ Contract
- ☐ Start
- ☐ Value
- ☐ End
- ☐ Contact Name
- ☐ Contact phone number

"It's not about ideas. It's about making ideas happen."
– Scott Belsky, co-founder Behance

Objectives I've completed today:

Objectives I've had difficulty with:

Possible ways to solve my problems:

What should I revisit tomorrow:

Final thought of the day:

Part 1 Progress Review

Company website and email	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
Gives your company a digital footprint and establishes professionalism and validity.	Are you satisfied with your company's website?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have access to a personal email address with your company's url?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Is there a clear and defined message established by your company's website?	☐YES ☐NO	
Capability Statement	**Ask yourself...**		**Action Plan**
Your company's one page document of your business proficiencies. This will provide specific information that will convince potential customers to do business with you	Do you access to a capability statement that can be revisied?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you provided company data such as DUNS, CAGE code, NAICS codes?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you established bullet points of your companies expertise that is revelant to your target?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Is there a clear point of contact for your company?	☐YES ☐NO	
DUNS Number	**Ask yourself...**		**Action Plan**
The federal government uses the DUNS number to track how federal money is allocated, so, it's neccessary to create a profile for your business.	Have you registered for a DUNS number?	☐YES ☐NO	

SAM.gov	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
SAM, System for Award Management, is used if you want to successfully pursue a government contract, it is essential that you register your business in the federal government's vendor database.	Is this information accurate to your business?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have your CAGE code?	☐YES ☐NO	
DSBS profile	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
Dynamic Small Business Search (DSBS) is used for entering and searching small business sources that want to do business with the Federal Government.	Have you determined what certificates apply to your business?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Is your DSBS profile accurate and have current information?	☐YES ☐NO	

Part 2
Research

Part 2 Inital Assessment

Agencies	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
Federal agencies are special government organizations set up for a specific purpose such as, the management of resources, financial oversight of industries, or national security issues.	Do you know what agencies you will be working with?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Are you able to find the Point of Contact to the agenices you wish to work with?	☐YES ☐NO	
Agency Research	**Ask yourself...**		**Action Plan**
Being able to find information relevant to the agencies you aim to work with will increase your success rate.	Are you able to build your own forecast list?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have the supplies an agency is attempting to buy?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you reached out to an OSDBU about what is needed in their agency?	☐YES ☐NO	
Prime contractors	**Ask yourself...**		**Action Plan**
Prime contractors work directly with the government. They manage any subcontractors, and are responsible for ensuring that the work is completed as defined in the contract.	Do you have a list of prime contractors that your company can work with?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Are you able to register bidders lists for local primes?	☐YES ☐NO	

Meetings with Agencies or Primes	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
Keeping in contact with agencies or primes will allow your business to be in the forefront when new opportunities arise.	Have you identified meet and greets you'd like to particpate in your industry?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you called an OSDBU for a meeting?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you created an unique capability statement to reflect the needs that you're trying to fulfill?	☐YES ☐NO	

Additional notes:

Identify Top Ten Customers

Forecast list for Agencies

USA Spending and Federal Procurement Data System (FPDS) tracks government spending in billions of dollars. These sites are great for aggregating the latest procurement information from a variety of agencies.

The forecast, is a list of potential job/contracts that federal agencies would like to purchase. These jobs may or may not be let for bid, but keeping an eye on this list allows contractors an opportunity to keep an eye on job/contract.

Using beta.SAM.gov is where federal agencies post available procurement opportunities valued at more than $25,000. You may search using a keyword that is relevant to the product or service you want to sell to the government. You can search for specific agencies that best suits your business. You can also search this database for past contract awards to better understand the market size and competition.

Your local PTAC can assist in the creation of a list of contracts that are relevant to your business, cutting down the need to scour through the beta.SAM database daily. There are some PTAC that will do this for free but every office is different be prepared to pay just in case!

Recommended source:

Here is what to look for when researching a forecast list:

- Projects that you can self perform or have performed in the past
- Projects that you can assemble a great team
- Projects that you identify a problem or propose a solution
- POC information for decision makers on any above projects

Here is an example of how to use the next few pages.

Customer Management List example

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
John Doe	Dept of Defense	123 Main Street New City, America 01234	Office:(555) 555-5555 Cell: (111)111-1111 Fax: N/A
Notes			
Spoke with John 5/12/2021 Waiting on forecast list; if haven't received will contact in two weeks.			

Upcoming Projects List example

Project Name	Solicitation #	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
GSA Energy management	July			2021 (Q3)
Notes				
Left a voicemail with Tony to see if he'll be able to assist in this project. Send an email in two days if no response.				

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Customer Management List

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info
Notes			

Upcoming Projects Lists

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Upcoming Projects Lists

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Upcoming Projects Lists

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Upcoming Projects Lists

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Upcoming Projects Lists

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Project Name	Solicitation Number	Sources Sought	Pre-solicitation	Due Date
Notes				

Where to find the Point Of Contact (POC) information for agencies

Most of us are familiar with the term “federal awards.” However, what most people don’t know is that there’s a USAspending.gov site that has all sorts of government data on federal awards. This site is a great resource for anyone looking to track government awards by state, congressional district, county, city, and zip code — in one central location.

Federal Procurement Data System (FPDS) is the repository of all federal contracting data. Using it, you can learn about federal contracting opportunities as well as which agencies have contracts, what agencies buy, and which vendors have contracts.

If you’re looking for government contact information, check out the beta.SAM.gov website. You can search for federal government contacts using a variety of different categories and keywords. Since there are thousands of people working in government offices across the country, they aren’t always organized into standard business names or departments; this gives you a good place to start looking for contact information.

Here are a list of titles that will help you sift through the information:

OSDBU - advocates for small firms
Contracting Officers (a.k.a. CO / KO / COR) - awards contracts
Customer / End User - has problems / needs
Prime Contracto - has current contracts onsite
Program Manger / Engineer - writes the requirements

Recommended source:

How Much Does Our Government ACTUALLY Buy? - https://youtu.be/TrCz52xk5MM

How to get AWARD Data from USA Spending? - https://youtu.be/Hr_U9z1xK2g

How To Find The 5 Players & Layers Of Government Contracting with Judy Bradt - https://bit.ly/38E3mmm

Point Of Contact (POC) information example

Agency Name: Department of Energy

Website: energy.gov

Mailing Address: 1000 Independence Ave SW, Room 5B-194 Washington, DC 20585

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU	John Doe	10 years	Open to new business based on commerical successes	
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Gather Point Of Contact (POC) information for Top 10 agencies

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Agency Name: _____

Website: _____

Mailing Address: _____

Primary Agency Phone Number: _____

	Contact Info	Experience Level	Small business friendly (?)	Challenges
OSDBU				
CO / KO / COR				
Customer / End User				
Prime Contractor				
Program Manger / Engineer				

Additional Notes:

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Once you've gathered the information in the previous pages it's time to contact these people. Sometimes the information will be outdated or another person will be the point of contact. The road to speaking with the right person will lead you down paths you might not have thought of.

Here is an example of how to use the next few pages.

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes
John Doe	GSA Schedule	Chicago, Il	(555) 555-5555 Doe_John@web-site.chi	referred to me from by GSA OSDBU
Jane Doeing	Army National Guard OSDBU	Service Center, VA	(555)555-5555	No answer will contact again

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

Contact Top Ten Agencies

Contact Name	Agency	Address	Contact Info	Notes

How to prepare for capability briefings

It is essential to know the NAICS codes for your products or services. Government agencies will not issue broad pre-solicitation, solicitations, RFPs without the need being classified. So, knowing where your product/service stands is a big part of the battle. This has already been covered previously and now it's time to put that information to use.
The information about codes will help you with the marketing research to make sure that you are able to provide the needs of the particular agency you're attempting to work with.

Here are some questions to ask yourself before you schedule a meeting with anyone at an agency:

- Do you know what this agency buys and at what price?
- Have you identified projects/opportunities that you are interested in?
- Do you have an elevator pitch that will propose a solution to a problem an agency has?
- Have you developed a forecast list for this agency?
- Do you know another person that you would like to meet within this agency?

Let's not forget about capability statements! These need to be customized to the specified need of the agency you've decided to target. You can include information about your current and past performance with both agency customers—especially if you have no prior experience—as well as with commercial customers.

Here are some points to hit when creating your capability statement:

- Clearly articulate your value proposition to that agency
- Demonstrate past performance relative to what that agency buys
- Highlight team accomplishments
- Showcase to the reader that your company is as low risk as possible
- Articulate what your company does

Makes sure that you are prepared for the next step; setting up capability briefings with the top ten agencies of your choice!

Setup cap briefings with Top 10 agencies

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"When times are bad is when the real entrepreneurs emerge."
-Robert Kiyosaki, founder Cashflow Technologies Inc.

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"Most great people have attained their greatest success just one step beyond their greatest failure."
-Napoleon Hill

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"If what you are doing is not moving you towards your goals, then it's moving you away from your goals."
– Brian Tracy, CEO Brian Tracy International

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"Success is not in what you have, but who you are."
-Bo Bennett, founder eBookit.com

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"Failure is not about insecurity, it's about lack of execution."
– Jeffery Gitomer, business trainer

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"What do you need to start a business? Three simple things: know your product better than anyone, know your customer, and have a burning desire to succeed."
–Dave Thomas, founder Wendy's

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"Make your team feel respected, empowered and genuinely excited about the company's mission."
–Tim Westergen, Pandora Founder

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"Your most unhappy customers are your greatest source of learning."
-Bill Gates, founder and CEO Microsoft

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"If you just work on stuff that you like and you're passionate about, you don't have to have a master plan with how things will play out."
–Mark Zuckerberg, founder and CEO Facebook

Date _____ Time_____AM/PM

Agency Name: _____

Point of Contact: _____

Title: _____

Location: _____

_____

Optional resources to consider to take:

☐Business cards ☐Additional person ☐Notepad and pen

Additional notes:

"Wonder what your customer really wants? Ask. Don't tell."
–Lisa Stone, co-founder and CEO BlogHer

Identify
Top Ten
Prime Contractors

Prime contractors and you

No matter how lucrative the prime contract awards or subcontracting opportunities are, spending your time on the hunt is always a good idea. You'll learn, grow, and make more money in the long run. Also, this is a great way to get experience and establish your business through subcontracting. After doing subcontract contracts, you'll have a much better chance at winning prime contracts that pay a lot better.

Finding Prime Contractors

Take a look at who the prime contractors are doing large quantities of work for in the federal government. As an example, if your a construction business that uses specialized equipment, then contact prime contractors that could possibly involve you as a subcontractor. Most likely, they'll love earning a new contact and will keep you in mind when dealing with upcoming federal contracts. It never hurts to ask!

In this new era, companies must look beyond their immediate vicinity. One resource to use is beta.SAM.gov - this government site contains a list of companies that have been awarded contracts.

Identifying the Right Contacts

A small business liaison officer or diversity officer is a piece of crucial information to find when looking to subcontract with a prime contractor. These liaisons ensure that the prime business is meeting the small business requirements set by agency contracts. They're the link between their headquarters and the world of small businesses. If you're unable to find one, you should ask if there is a small business subcontracting plan administrator.

Once you find who the Point Of Contact is be sure to write down all relevant information.

Here is some information to obtain before you contact a prime -

- Do you know what that prime buys
- Identify projects or opportunities that you are interested in
- Have a proposed solution to a problem that you heard about
- Spoke with an OSDBU from a government agency regarding that prime
- Know a person that you would like to meet within the organization
- Have a non public bid opportunity to bring to them

When you obtained the information above be sure to create a custom capability statement that will be relevant to the prime. These are the points you'll need hit -

- Clearly articulate your value proposition to prime
- Demonstrate past performance work or commercial relative to what the prime buys
- Highlight team accomplishments
- Give the person on the other end warm and fuzzies that you are low risk
- Articulate that you understand government contracting

Get the Point Of Contact (POC) information for Top 10 local primes

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"Money is like gasoline during a road trip. You don't want to run out of gas on your trip, but you're not doing a tour of gas stations."
– Tim O'Reilly, founder and CEO O'Reilly Media

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"Chase the vision, not the money, the money will end up following you."
– Tony Hsieh, CEO Zappos

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"Get big quietly, so you don't tip off potential competitors."
– Chris Dixon, co-founder and CEO Hunch

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"Don't play games that you don't understand, even if you see lots of other people making money from them."
– Tony Hsieh, CEO Zappos

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"Always deliver more than expected."
– Larry Page, co-founder Google

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"We are really competing against ourselves, we have no control over how other people perform."
– Pete Cashmore, founder and CEO Mashable

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"You just have to pay attention to what people need and what has not been done."
– Russell Simmons, found Def Jam Records

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"No matter how brilliant your mind or strategy, if you're playing a solo game, you'll always lose out to a team"
– Reid Hoffman, co-founder LinkedIn

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"You can't ask customers what they want and then try to give that to them. By the time you get it built, they'll want something new."
– Steve Jobs, founder, chairman and CEO Apple Inc.

Company Name _____

Website _____

Mailing Address _____

Primary Business Phone _____

Primary POC Name _____

Primary POC Phone _____

Primary POC Email Address _____

Additional notes:

"Hire character. Train skill."
– Peter Schultz, founder and director GNF

See if top suppliers have any upcoming bid opportunities

Prime contractors work with the government, subcontracting any work to other companies or individuals, and doing all that is required to ensure the work is completed according to contract requirements.

As far as building a relationship with the government goes, it is important. You need to develop long-term relationships in order to ever be able to bid on any government contracts. Working under a prime contractor is a great way to jump into the federal marketplace. However, subcontractors usually don't directly interact with the government.

How does a small business get involved in federal contracts?

The federal government has an awesome procurement process that helps small businesses get involved in federal contracting. Bigger firms, like your competitors, have to contract out with smaller companies — meaning more opportunities for small businesses to win federal contracts.

This is good news for small businesses. Some government contracts have a requirement that they use small business subcontractors to perform the work. This expands opportunities for small business participation and makes dollars available for small businesses to get involved in federal contracting.

Some federal contracts require a subcontracting plan for a small business to outsource work. In order for a subcontractor to be awarded this work, the contracting officer will include specific subcontracting goals for the prime contractor to try to meet.

Any large U.S. business can publicize job openings, task notices, and job solicitations to the SubNet — a service of the U.S. Small Business Administration (SBA) designed to make finding small business subcontractors easier and more accessible.

Remember that Prime contractors will need to know about your business. They will want to know:

- If you are a small business that has certifications such as; HUBZone, or Veteran-owned Businesses, 8(a) and women-owned small businesses (WOSBs).
- If you had any type of past experience with other Prime contractors, private sector contracts of similar scale or, worked with Federal agencies.
- If you have the capabilities and sufficient resources to meet the contractual requirements.

We recommend that you make it a habit to visit workshops, conferences and government business events to meet potential partners. Having a solid list of skills, abilities and expertise can be helpful to present your skills as a viable subcontractor. The more effort you put into getting to know the other party, the more likely you'll be selected to work together.

You've already found the Point of Contact for the prime contractors you're interested in.

Call each one for more information about what they would need and how you can be utilitzed for future projects.

Recommended source:

For federal contracts, competitors may be your greatest source of opportunity - https://youtu.be/AzmZUgPRFPo

Contact email/call Top 10 local primes

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"The difference between a boss and a leader: a boss says 'Go!' – a leader says, 'Let's go!'."
-E.M Kelly, U.S Army

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"A business that makes nothing but money is a poor business."
– Henry Ford, founder Ford Motor Company

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"It's almost always harder to raise capital than you thought it would be, and it always takes longer. So plan for that."
-Richard Harroch, Venture Capitalist

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"The things we fear the most in organizations- fluctuations, disturbances, imbalances – are the primary sources of creativity."
– Margaret Wheatley, management consultant

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"Effective communication is 20% what you know and 80% how you feel about what you know."
-Jim Rohn

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"Stay self-funded as long as possible."
– Garrett Camp, founder Expa, Uber and StumbleUpon

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"Turn a perceived risk into an asset."
– Aaron Patzer, founder Mint

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"It's more effective to do something valuable than to hope a logo or name will say it for you."
– Jason Cohen, founder Smart Bear Software

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"Don't worry about funding if you don't need it. Today it's cheaper to start a business than ever."
– Noah Everett, founder Twitpic

Contacted using:

☐ LETTER ☐ EMAIL ☐ PHONE CALL

Reason for contacting:

S	M	Tu	W	Th	F	Sat
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Date _____

Time_____ AM/PM

Follow up _____ days/weeks later

Additional Notes:

"Data beats emotions."
– Sean Rad, founder Adly and Tinder

Attend site visit with local primes

Depending on your industry, site visits may not be key. If you work in Construction, Energy, Facilities Management or similar, then visits are extremely important for the following reasons:

Information, Pricing, and Quality Responses

The key to deepening intelligence is active listening. Get your staff out there into the field and listen carefully. Capturing all the information and documentation from site visits is vital for making intelligent decisions about the tasks.

Whether you have a specific service or product you will have the benefit of site visits from individuals who can provide feedback that you would not be able to find elsewhere. This feedback can show the most realistic cost for your particular service or product that will allow you to price it in a way that is realistic and helpful to your customers.

Site visits are invaluable for gathering details that will strengthen your quality responses, especially those related to Health & Safety, Contract Implementation, and Risk Assessment & Mitigation.

You can ensure any uncertainties you have about the tender documentation prior to submission. With a competitive tender process, there is always room for confusion. The clearer and more detailed your submission, the less room for error.

Making the most out of your site visits:

Know as much as you can about the customer before you start talking. This will save time by avoiding wasted questions or conversations that are better off not happening. It will also help you better understand the buyer, their needs and what it is they want to accomplish.

You can come to the meeting with a sense of confidence. You've done the research, but the important thing is to listen carefully and contribute to the discussion. You can also bring "to-do" lists that help you remember key things you'll need to talk about.

Be confident, show that you're engaged, and ask questions — even if you think the answer is probably obvious. If people see you are at ease and interested in the conversation, they'll be more inclined to trust your advice. You look stronger and more professional when you're engaged in discussions.

It's important to understand what type of Buyer you're dealing with. You'll have the ability to personalize your technical specifications documents to reflect their work culture. Visual cues — such as everyday health and safety — will help you pinpoint what aspects of your job that are most critical to them.

Recommend source:
This is why SITE VISITS are important! Listen- https://youtu.be/_AI35pVtv38

Attend site visit with Top 10 local primes

Site visits allow an agency to assess awardees capability, performance, and compliance against the applicable elements that make up each award.

Be sure to make an appointment to visit a site.

Visiting a site will be as either a prime, sub-contractor, or as a consultant.

Take a person from the prime company that is profiecent with the demands of the contract. A person who knows what is expected from both the contractor and agency.

Be mindfully that sometimes photographs of the site will not be permitted.

After the entire site visits are complete, type up your notes while they are fresh in your mind. Don't wait until you get back to the office; do it at the end of each evening and be sure to confer with your team about your notes. Upload them to the cloud and invite all individuals that were at the first meeting to review and comment on them.

What you may need for a site visit:

☐ An additional person ☐ notepad and pen ☐ Knowledge of the contract

What else would you bring with you to the site visits?

Recommended source:
Contractors please listen to your customers, they will state their needs - https://youtu.be/Zfvqq11PVQQ

Register bidders list for Top 10 local primes

Winning prime contracts is tough. If you're lucky enough to make it onto a prime contractor's preferred vendor list, you're one step closer to success. This can be the difference between being a small, unknown business and a large, successful contractor. Most prime contractors maintain lists of preferred vendors and subcontractors based on quality and timeliness of their work. Winning government contract work is critical for any business. Adding your business to an approved vendor list can be a way to elevate your standing with the right federal agency, which can result in greater opportunity.

Each prime contractor has its own process when considering which vendors to include on its preferred vendor list, so a standard form template doesn't exist. If you're an applicant and want to be included, contact the prime's purchasing department or small business liaison to request a copy of a preferred vendor application.

Even though each application will be unique here are some common records to keep on hand when filling them out.

☐ Size of your business	☐ Past business experience	☐ Financial status
☐ Management staff capabilities	☐ Your company's experience with labor relations	☐ Work capacity and/or bonding capacity
☐ Product service record	☐ Facilities	☐ Professional credentials
☐ Reputation	☐ Reference checks	☐ company records

Additional notes:

Do meet and greet events with Top 10 local primes

To find primes that work directly with an agency you could ask an OSDBU for a list, head to the website of the agency and find a complied list there, or search through your relevant NAICS codes to find what company had the top annual sales for that particular code.

Once you find the primes you wish to affliate with now you must find a way to develop a relationship. Meet the prime events will be organized either by an agency to promote relationship development between large and small businesses or by the large business itself.

To find these events be on the look out for industry relevant news. Larger companies will host events so they can be exposed to more subcontracting firms and so both could learn more about partnership opportunities on major projects.

There will be third party organizations that will host events that gather multiple large companies so that they can meet with smaller companies. To find these it'll be best to speak with your local PTAC or an internet search.

Additional notes:

Part 2 Progress Assessment

Agencies	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
Agencies are permanent organizations that are responsible for implementing and controlling the functions of the government.	Did you find an OSBDU for each of the agencies you want to work with?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Did you find a forecast list for the agencies you want to work with?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have more than three POC for each of the agencies you wish to work with?	☐YES ☐NO	
Agency Research	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
	Are you able to identify the projects you are interested in?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Did you do contract research on previous contracts for opportunities?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Do you have a proposed solution for their problem?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Did you do contract research on previous contracts for opportunities?	☐YES ☐NO	
Prime Contractors	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
	Do you have a non-public opportunity you can take to a prime?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Are you able to highlights your team accomplishments and performances in the commercial and or government arena to a prime?	☐YES ☐NO	

Meetings	Ask yourself...		Action Plan
	Have you found at least five relevant industry events you can attend?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you spoke to an OSD-BU about what events you should attend?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Are you maximizing your time by setting up meetings with different agencys/prime contractors on the same trip?	☐YES ☐NO	
	Have you identified any events strictly for prime or as a subcontractor?	☐YES ☐NO	

Part 3
Events

Attend OSDBU recommended events

OSDBU hosts and sponsors many successful events that bring together the next generation of small business leaders and experienced individuals. This is a way groups of businesses benefits from being exposed to new ideas, collaboration, and networking opportunities.

These conferences and events will become a great way to build your connections, learn new skills, and meet people that you can collaborate with on future projects.

Finding out about events in the area is vital to being seen as an expert in your field. The best way to find out about events is to call the OSDBU that you work with. Also, you can look for events, seminars, workshops that have been organized by or sponsored by an OSDBU.

Additional notes:

Attend industry specific events

If you can meet a goal of attending one event per year, or one-per-month, you're already ahead of the game. It's never too late to start learning about and attending industry events. Finding the appropriate event might require some research, but it's worth it.

Before committing to the large annual conference or expo-type event, I highly recommend checking the attendee list.

- Who do you want to meet there?
- What are your goals?
- Are your goals similar to those of the companies in attendance?
- Are there other businesses there that interest you in possible team ups?

If not, maybe it's not the event for you.

One of the best ways to market your product or service at an event is to network. People in attendance are upscale consumers and savvy businesspersons who often attend the shows in order to learn about new products and discuss industry trends with executives and marketing experts. Instead of haggling, aim to engage attendees as potential customers by sharing valuable insights.

While these events can be a great use of your time and money, they also often cost quite a bit more. To offset that cost, there are some ways to maximize your educational experience. For example, when possible you should try to choose the most popular sessions so you can meet with more people from your industry and learn new things that are relevant to your company's needs.

Additional notes:

Attend PTAC events

How to find a local PTAC

Do an internet search for PTAC [Your State Name] or head to the offical SBA website and locate Procurement Technical Assistance Centers. The last way to find a PTAC is to head to aptac-us.org and using this site to find your local PTAC. Here you'll be able to find the closest office that will assist you on your Federal contracting journey.

Seminars and events

Depending on the event or seminar there may be a fee so be ready to pay. For some third party PTAC organizations there may also be a membership fee that you'll be expected to pay yearly.

Organization Name

Contact Name

Phone

Fax

Email address

Address

Hours of operation

Additional notes:

Name of event	Scheduled	Referred by	Who will attend that I should meet	What will I learn here

Name of event	Scheduled	Referred by	Who will attend that I should meet	What will I learn here

Name of event	Scheduled	Referred by	Who will attend that I should meet	What will I learn here

Name of event	Scheduled	Referred by	Who will attend that I should meet	What will I learn here

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Name of event	Scheduled	Referred by	Who will attend that I should meet	What will I learn here

Name of event	Scheduled	Referred by	Who will attend that I should meet	What will I learn here

Part 4
Advance

Identify local contract award winners and solicit

The most important thing you can do to begin a prime contract search is to identify the contract number or solicitation number. The Federal Procurement Data System Standard (FPDS) / System for Award Management (SAM) online will give you this information! If you can't find it there, call the original contracting officer and try to get the old numbers.

If you are having trouble finding a contract or solicitation and need further research, you may want to check out the Office of Small Business Programs/Office of Small Business Utilization (OSBP/OSBU). These offices are created to help small businesses get a slice of any government pie. The Office of Small and Disadvantaged Business Utilization (SDBU) can be your best friend. If they are unable to find the solicitation numbers go to the Federal Procurement Data System, a tool that lets you search for solicitations and opportunities on the entire federal procurement market.

When you find these contract actions, you may very well discover the one that matches the description of the current sources-sought, draft solicitation, or RFP. Once you have found the contract in FPDS / SAM, and identified the incumbent, look them up in SAM [System for Award Management] to find out more information about the organization.

After reviewing their profile in SAM, I check out their website. (At this point, I'm trying to find out more about the company). If they're on GSA eLibrary I check there next. Then I return to FPDS/SAM and search FPDS by Global DUNS number and get to work!

Now you have found a lot of information about a prime contractor and there's still another website to check. Use the Global DUNS number to search for more contracts where the prime contractor subcontracted on other services. While researching contracts awarded and past performance for another prime contractor, use USASpending.gov for subcontracting work.

The first step of an effective solicitation is getting your company's name out there. Most solicitations will have you start with the basics: your company's name, address, ownership status, length of time in business, DUNS number, tax identification number, and a principal contact. Additionally, you should include your company's history, management strategy, and any other qualities that set you apart from other subcontractors. Focus on the strengths to set you apart from the competition and make your company easier to remember. If you're a large firm, highlight your ability to manage projects, how long you have been in business, and what makes you unique from other subcontractors. Be sure to include information about your company's relevant experience on projects that are similar to the one you're interested in. The prime contractor may also want to know if your company is a minority- or woman-owned business, has received certification as a disadvantaged business enterprise (DBE), or is certified as green. You will likely be asked to include information about licenses and industry certifications too.

Whether it's a short letter or a lengthy report, you should present a complete description of the functions and capabilities your organization can perform for the prime contractor. Be prepared to articulate exactly what your company is bringing to the project. This may include deadlines for the start and completion of work, as well as the types of labor requirements that will be performed by your business. It's a good idea to include particulars about design review, testing, training and other necessary tasks. The key to this area of the proposal is to empower the contractor you'll be hiring. Who is in charge? How will accountability be ensured and checked? Make sure you let your prospective contractor know what process you will be employing to ensure that the work will get done on time and within budget.

The budget is a crucial part of every proposal and can often be the deciding factor in awarding a contract. Your budget should explain how much a contract with your company will cost and why, and should include a fairly high level of detail. Explain all the components and direct costs of the project, such as salaries, supplies, materials, and travel and legal fees. It should also include all potential price increases, rising material costs or other factors that could change over time. Especially with pricing information, be transparent about your indirect costs. All businesses, large and small, must account for their overhead. When you quote a cost to a potential client, be prepared to answer questions and explain why certain costs are included in the overall price. For example, the prime contractor may question the travel budget and have you break it down into the number of necessary business trips. Or, why you spent money on a specific piece of equipment.

Applying for that big contract means you will have to present your qualifications and your plan to ultimately impress the contracting company. The more information you provide about your capabilities in the proposal, the easier it will be to convince the company of your value. However, you should not be afraid to offer more information if asked. It is important to stress why you are a good fit for the project.

Monitor Sources Sought and respond

What is a Sources Sought Notice?

The Sources Sought Notice is an announcement posted by a government agency that states they are seeking possible sources for a project. The Sources Sought Notice is a summary of a government agency's goal to improve small business access to specific project. It is not a solicitation, nor is it a request for proposal. It is an advance notice — a heads up — on what is to come. So remember this is a great way to stay informed about potential projects, and it's essential to know what to expect.

What's the point of a Sources Sought Notice?

Market research helps government agencies better understand the market's abilities to satisfy an agency's needs. In 1994, the Federal Acquisition Streamlining Act defined market research as an important step in the procurement process. Market research is a way to collect information about how organizations are able to satisfy their needs and to see if any contractors are interested or even able to do the scope of work.

It can also help agencies understand what they need, what options are available, and what terms are most suitable to different situations. An agency will determine whether two or more small businesses, including 8(a), WOSB, and HUBZone businesses, can meet the requirements for set-asides or whether a modification is needed.

Agencies want to identify commercial practices and strategies. These include warranties, licenses, buyer financing, maintenance programs, terms & conditions, and commercial discounts. This information will help agencies get the best price/best value for their government.

Where are Sources Sought notices?

These can be found in a few places; most are posted and searched for in BETA.sam. You can also find some at an agencies website, GSA, eBuy, even LinkedIn. It's best to check more than one place to maximize the amount of opportunities.

Don't forget to sign up on a Watchlist! It will send you an email whenever a new solicitation is available for an agency. Do this so you can stay in-the-know and the list of "Interested Vendors" will help you spot potential teammates and potential competitors.

Why respond to Sources Sought notices?

Responding to these gets your foot in the door. Plain and simple. Responding to these Sources Sought notices is an easy way to tell the government that your company is ready and able to secure government work. Or, you can wait until the official solicitation is issued but if you want to win government contracts, really give your company the best chance by staying in the know through Sources Sought opportunities.

When putting together a response keep these in mind…

Give specific examples of relevant experience that relate to each of the tasks outlined in the project scope and statement of work. Also, explain in what past projects have been completed by explaining if any had been completed as a sub or prime. If your company hasn't done government contracts before be ready to explain what has been completed similarly to the project in question. If your company has completed projects for other agency's be sure to name the specific agency. Detail your work: the contract number, agency, scope/value, length, functions, and role you played. Be sure to go into detail regardless of what your company's relevant past performances is. Don't assume they know already what types of skills you possess or that an agency will do research beyond what you give.

Identify IDV opportunities

What is an Indefinite Delivery Vehicle (IDV)?

FAR Subpart 4.601 defines Indefinite Delivery Vehicles (IDV) as, "an indefinite delivery contract or agreement that has one or more of the following clauses:
(1) 52.216-18, Ordering.
(2) 52.216-19, Order Limitations.
(3) 52.216-20, Definite Quantity.
(4) 52.216-21, Requirements.
(5) 52.216-22, Indefinite Quantity.
(6) Any other clause allowing ordering."

Governmental bodies and the military use long-term contracts for product maintenance and other purchases. These agreements are most often referred to as Indefinite Delivery (IDV) contracts and IDVs are similar to Indefinite Delivery/Indefinite Quantity (IDIQ) contracts.

These types of contracts are under IDV contracts:

- Basic Ordering Agreements (BPA)
- Basic Purchasing Agreements (BPA)
- Letter Contracts
- Blanket Purchase Agreements (BPA)
- Indefinite Delivery Contracts (IDC)
- Government-Wide Acquisition Contract (GWAC)
- Federal Supply Schedule

The indefinite delivery, indefinite quantity contracts are used when government services cannot be predicted. They provide for an indefinite amount of supplies or services over the time period of a contract. IDIQ contracts help streamline the contract process and speed up service delivery.

IDIQ contracts allow the government to place orders for each specific need, such as supplies or services, instead of one general order for all. Under this contract, the government places orders for individual needs like supplies or services. The government sets minimum and maximum quantity limits, which can be the number of supplies or a dollar value for services.

IDVs will either be single agency or multi-agency. Single agency IDVs is when your company will deal with only one agency. A multi-agency IDV functions like a Government-Wide Acquisition Contract (GWAC) in that there are multiple agencies involved. When looking at these contracts be sure to look to distinguish what type it is.

Find industry specific bids/presolicitation to contact OSDBU/SBLO

Government agencies will publish pre-solicitation notices before beginning the solicitation process. This process helps the Government gauge contractor interest in the upcoming solicitation and determines whether there are qualified contractors capable of doing the work. It also helps agencies decide if a solicitation should be considered for any set aside. Presolicitations and Sources Sought are similar with the difference being that pre-solicitations might have the research accumulated from the Sources Sought. Both are part of the planning process and neither are guaranteed to turn into a contract.

The proposal process includes three very important elements:

1. For this project, you have to address the Statement of Work (SOW) and solve it. Any generic sales brochures or cookie-cutter company descriptions won't work. You must show your knowledge of this opportunity by writing directly to what the government is requesting and then provide technical volume as written in the SOW. Only provide the information relevant to the SOW, there isn't a need to have any extra value work.

2. Providing strong references of relevant experience is the best way to convince potential clients that you are the right service provider for the job. The best way to get new

3. Having an accurate price of your work is important. If the price is too low or too high, that could be a red flag, meaning that the agency might think you don't really know what you're doing.

You'll be able to find some Presolicitations at beta.SAM.gov

Once you find a presolicitation that interests you and submitted your documents. It's time to check in with your local OSDBU. OSDBUs will make sure that any small business concerned with doing business with a particular agency understands what their process is. OSDBUs will help small businesses succeed by finding opportunities for them to contract with the government and working with businesses to reduce barriers to entry.

Expand website to include new federal and local content delivered

You need to highlight your company's government contracting experience. It'll benefit your company greatly if you show the government what you've done in the past and how you work with agencies. By showcasing that your company has the skills and abilities necessary to understand big projects and also meet the needs of an agency. So, by seeing your credentials, it will make the decision makers feel confident that they can rely on you for the work they're hiring for.

Here are a few things you should include on this new page.

- A list of all your commercial projects (if you don't have any federal projects completed)
- Testimonials from other companies that have worked with you
- Add a government agency or client logos that you've worked for
- Add any certifications that your company has received (WOSB, SDVOSB, etc.)
- Include past contract awards

Another way to showcase your work is to post videos of employees speaking about or working on projects. Alternatively, show the process of creating your products/services.

Use supplier credit and payoff immediately after recieving funds

In order to be successful in business, you must get many of your supplies from outside. A good way to ensure this is by having a good relationship with your vendors. Suppliers often offer discounts if they get advance payment. However, you can still receive goods without making an upfront payment if you have a good relationship with your suppliers. This is known as trade credit.

When suppliers extend trade credit to you, most will set a maximum amount. The decision to extend credit to a business is usually based on the supplier's credit policy. The amount of credit extended to your business is based on each supplier's estimation of your creditworthiness as well as your capacity to pay for purchases. If you're a new supplier to them, they may want to see an official financial report from your business and they might ask you to fill out an application. If you're a new supplier to them, they may ask you for financial information about your business. They'll need to see an official report from a third party like your accountant.

This may be difficult to believe, but your suppliers will judge you based on how you've paid them in the past — and if payments are always prompt, they will extend credit to you more freely. If you're an existing customer of the supplier, the supplier's credit decision is based primarily on your payment history. If your payment history with suppliers shows a long history of payments being made on time, you can expect them to grant you greater amounts of credit.

Here's a list of advantages and disadvantages of supplier credit.

Advantages	Disadvantages
• By communicating regularly, you can be sure that you will keep up with new products, services, or industry trends (even if you owe money). • Suppliers may give discounts on quick payment which can save your business money. • Negotiate payment terms. This, along with deferring expenses, can give your business a competitive edge. • Paying early increases profit margins.	• You might face financial penalties if you aren't paying your suppliers in a timely fashion. • If you don't pay or are consistently late, you can damage your credit score. • If your company experiences a decrease in cash flow having open credit lines may be difficult to navigate.

It is suggested that after establishing a credit history with a business and growing with the company, a better credit term should be discussed with current suppliers. Begin by checking your competitors' prices and credit terms. Then, propose an increased credit line to your current supplier. If you are a loyal customer, they will likely be willing to match the lower price! Though it's within a suppliers right to refuse an offer so be ready to pivot to a new supplier if needed.

Look at team member's roles and responsibilities

What about post-project team evaluation? If a project was a failure or a success a team evaluation is needed to makes sure that a team is working efficient and effectively. It can be uncomfortable to go back through each detail, but evaluation is key to future success. To decide how to handle future projects, provide valuable insight into how you've handled prior projects. The following tips will evaluate team performance effectively and provide valuable insight into how to approach future projects.

- Before delving into the original purposes of this project, it is important to revisit the original goals of the project. By taking a step back, this allows you to be better informed and puts you in the right frame of mind to draw realistic conclusions. If you constantly have a view of the final outcomes in mind, your evaluation may be skewed.

- Evaluation interviews are a crucial step and can be conducted in a group or individually. This is also an important opportunity to practice interpersonal communication skills such as listening, asking good questions, and demonstrating confidence. Managers should select the best interview opportunity for each role to stage the best candidate for further development. You may find that group members are reluctant to share their thoughts in a group interview setting. This is because they are concerned about being judged or liking what others like. It is important to recognize that this expression of feelings may be different from the usual, so it is essential to ask the group members how they feel privately and individually. Group discussions can also be very useful to uncover any concerns that members may have about one another. This is the best opportunity to give constructive feedback to your employees. This discussion provides an opportunity for both employees and managers to provide feedback. It might be positive or negative feedback, but either way it will provide you with the information you need to improve efficiency and productivity within your organization. This is also a great way to build more accountability and team cohesion within your group.

- As a manager, you must be observant and attentive. You need to pay close attention to employee feedback throughout each interview process. Some employees may be unsure, anxious, or afraid to speak freely; and it is in your best interests to encourage them to share their experiences candidly. Be sure that all staff feels comfortable providing candid opinions and feedback. With this fresh perspective, you can use the information gained step-by-step to improve strengths and eradicate weaknesses in employee behavior.
- After conducting the interviews, sit down and analyze the project challenges. Consider not only the obvious deficiencies but also the delicate challenges, such as encountering unforeseen circumstances that you had not considered before the project began. Areas of analysis could include project deadlines, whether the staff upheld an industry standard, and whether staff was assigned to their proper tasks as per workflows.

Now that you have analyzed the feedback you'll be able to utilize what you learned in your interviews for future team projects. Areas that would benefit most from this information would be team delegation, set-

Meet with buyers (upcoming contract vehicles) and forecast list

A forecast list is a way of forecasting the upcoming projects for an agency. It's usually broken down by year or quarters. You'll be able to find forecast lists at Acquisition.gov. Once you have completed the search for contract vehicles and researched all upcoming projects, the next step is to approach the OSDBU. The OSDBU (Office of Small Disadvantaged Business Utilization) is responsible for enforcing laws that require government contracts to be awarded to small businesses and businesses owned by women, minorities, veterans, and people with disabilities. Speaking with OSDBUs is a good networking tool to foster because you might be able to gather information about a project that hasn't been written down or give you decision makers information.

Attend regular events in our market place along with federal customers

Nowadays, the internet is king when it comes to government events. Attending government events is a great way to target new clients and meet influential people. If you want to place yourself in the game of finding new federal business, look for opportunities to network at conferences and seminars. There are more than 1,000+ events scheduled over the course of the year, so it's important to choose your opportunities carefully. The OSDBU is a great place to start. Check out the events in your region or nearest city and go. Attendance at government events is an essential marketing tool for small businesses. Nothing sends a message more clearly than being present at these events. There are local groups all over the country that hold networking events, business classes, panel discussions, seminars, and more. These are perfect events for a new small business owner or enterprising entrepreneur looking to launch their company in a new market.

With so many events on a regular basis related to government business, there are bound to be some that are worth your time and money. Look for events related to government agencies such as the U.S. State Department or local city or county governments. Additionally, look into financing industry events, non-profit networking events, and apprenticeship training.

Here are lists of places you can go to find some events:

- GSA Events (https://bit.ly/3qEUvXU)
- GovEvents (https://bit.ly/2N8FXC2)
- FBC, Inc. (https://bit.ly/3ex4Umc)
- DoD Small Business (https://bit.ly/3vgtlKh)

GOVCON GIANTS

SUN	MON	TUES	WED	THUR	FRI	SAT

ACTION PLAN

REVISIT

PEOPLE TO CALL

CHECKLIST

NOTES

GOVCON GIANTS

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